

CANARY ISLANDS LANDING: OCCUPANTS REPORTED

Señor [REDACTED] to whom we are greatly indebted for this contribution, is the director of the A.A. Ovnis Investigation Group* of Portugalete in the Province of Vizcaya in northern Spain. The report, first published by journalist J.J. Benitez, received the endorsement of the Spanish Government and was supported by photographs. It is a detailed report of the remarkable "onion phobia" affair which appeared in one of our "World Round-Up" columns (FSR Vol. 22, No. 4). Translation from the Spanish by Gordon Creighton

ON OCTOBER 20, 1976, acting in a personal capacity, a Lieutenant-General in the Spanish Air Ministry in Madrid handed to the Bilbao journalist [REDACTED] thick file bearing the label "Report on UFOs."

This most unusual document, while it does not constitute an official statement on the part of the Spanish Government — as has been somewhat precipitately claimed in some quarters — nevertheless represents a quite exceptional new development in the whole field of UFO research in Spain.

The 78 folio sheets which compose this Report contain the documentation drawn up by Spanish Air Ministry personnel on twelve UFO cases, the majority of which cases are also vouched for by Air Force personnel as witnesses. The documentation is backed by numerous pieces of photographic evidence and also by a number of pieces of film taken by pilots of Spanish fighter aircraft, as well as by details of certain cases in which the UFOs were registered on the radar.

The summarized account of the sightings begins with a case in the Province of Sevilla on March 20, 1964, and concludes with the case of June 22, 1976, in the islands of Fuerteventura and Gran Canaria, Canary Islands.

The last-mentioned of these twelve cases, in the Canary Islands, was already known in Spanish UFO research circles. A report on it appeared in issue No. 26 of *Stendek*, journal of the C.E.I. (Spanish Centre for Interplanetary Studies, Barcelona). In our present Report we confine ourselves to this particular case.

In that report published in *Stendek* No. 26 mention was made of the fact that "somebody" with sufficient "pull" had attempted, at the time when this case happened, to "request" the principal eyewitness to say nothing about the affair, as a result of which intervention the C.E.I.'s own correspondent in the Canary Isles had been prevented from reporting on the details of the case at first hand.

The divulging of some of the official documentation on this case, carried out as it now has been in pretty sensational fashion, has thrown fresh and

definitive light upon the case, namely in the conclusions reached by the Air Ministry. Among these documentary materials now made available are important new eyewitness statements — additional to those previously known — plus the revelation of the existence of a big series of coloured photographs of the UFO.

The features of this case, plus the large number of witnesses and the high qualifications of the latter, plus the other pieces of corroborative evidence, and plus the fact that we can guarantee that it emanates from the Ministry — all these factors go to make this Canary Islands landing case one of the most important ever recorded in the course of UFO investigation in Spain.

Events of the night of June 22, 1976, over the Canaries

1. The Testimony

The UFO passed literally right across the whole of the Canary Island group, from East to West. The main concentrations of reports from witnesses who saw it come from three basic areas (See Map):—

- i) Area to S. of the Island of Fuerteventura.
- ii) Grand Canary, principally the northern part.
- iii) The islands lying further westwards: namely Tenerife, La Palma, Gomera, and Hierro.

Let us take them in order.

A: Here is a reproduction of the actual text of the despatch, file no. "01/76" dealing with this case, in the dossier handed to Sr. Benítez by the Lt. General from the Ministry. This relates to the first of the Canaries sightings (which had remained unknown until the Ministry released these documents):—

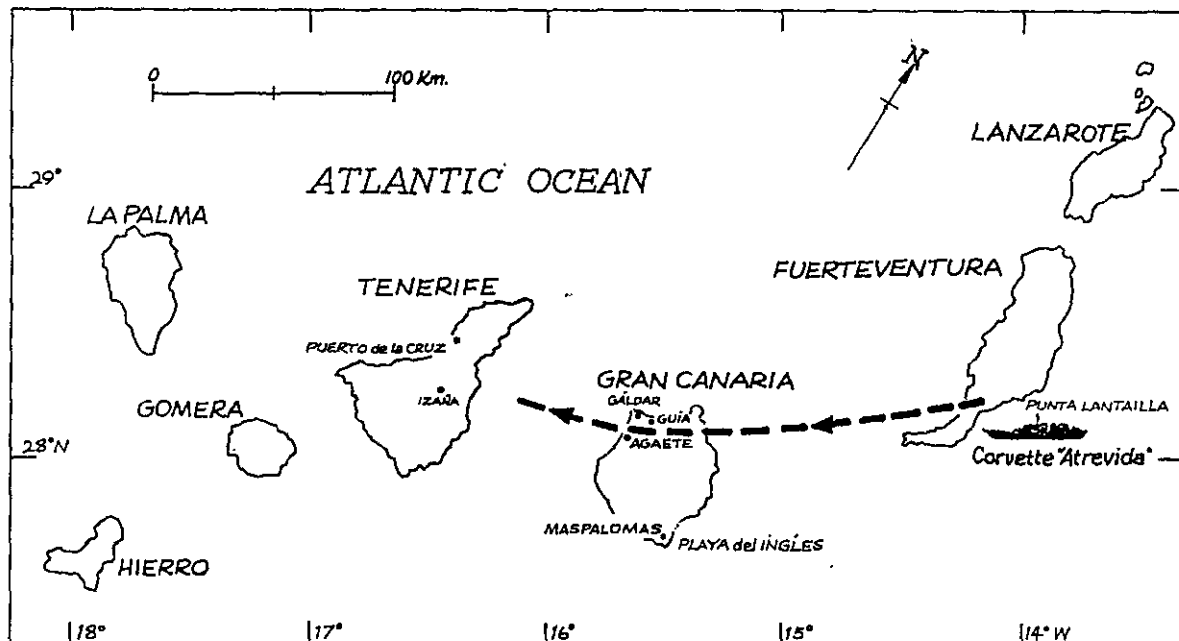
"At 21.27 (Z) hrs. on June 22, 1976, the corvette *Atrevida*, of the Spanish Navy, positioned at 3 NM, at 180 degrees from Punta Lantilla, on the south-eastern coast of the Island of Fuerteventura, observed the following phenomenon, as described by the ship's personnel, including the Commanding Officer (Captain) and the Ship's Ensign (witnesses numbered B-07 and B-08 respectively):

"At 21.27 (Z) hrs. on June 22, 1976, we saw a

* UFO Investigation Group A.A. OVNIS, address: [REDACTED] caya, Spain.

vivid ye
shore to
At first
lights on
elevation
original
began to
"It
minutes.
bluish l
position
phenom
"Tw
into two
centre c
appeared
had com
"Th
and irreg
movemer
way, wh
its glow
surface o
deduce t
from us, i
"(...)
by the w
south of
distance
position
three mir
km.p.h."

Right: TH
Atrevida,



The flight path of the UFO from Fuerteventura Island westwards to Tenerife via Grand Canary

vivid yellowish-cum-bluish light moving out from the shore towards our position, and climbing as it did so. At first we thought it was an aircraft with its landing lights on. Then, when the light had attained a certain elevation (15-18 degrees) it became stationary. The original light went out and a luminous beam from it began to rotate.

"It remained like this for approximately two minutes. Then a vivid great halo of yellowish and bluish light developed, and remained in the same position for 40 minutes, even though the original phenomenon was no longer visible.

"Two minutes after the great halo, the light split into two parts, the smaller part being beneath, in the centre of the luminous halo, there a blue cloud appeared and the part from which the bluish nucleus had come vanished.

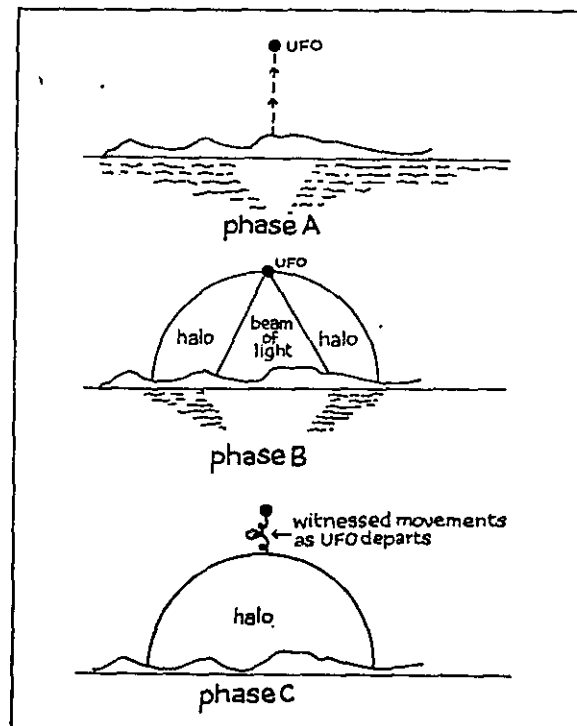
"The upper part began to climb in a spiral, rapid and irregular, and finally vanished. None of these movements affected the initial circular halo in any way, which remained just the same the whole time, its glow lighting up part of the land and part of the surface of the sea beneath it, from which we could deduce that the phenomenon was not very far away from us, but was close.

"(...) The strange object which had been observed by the witnesses aboard the Spanish warship, to the south of the Island of Fuerteventura, covered the distance of 85 nautical miles between the sighting position and the north of Grand Canary Island in three minutes, at an estimated speed of some 3,060 km.p.h." (See Trajectory as shown on Map and in

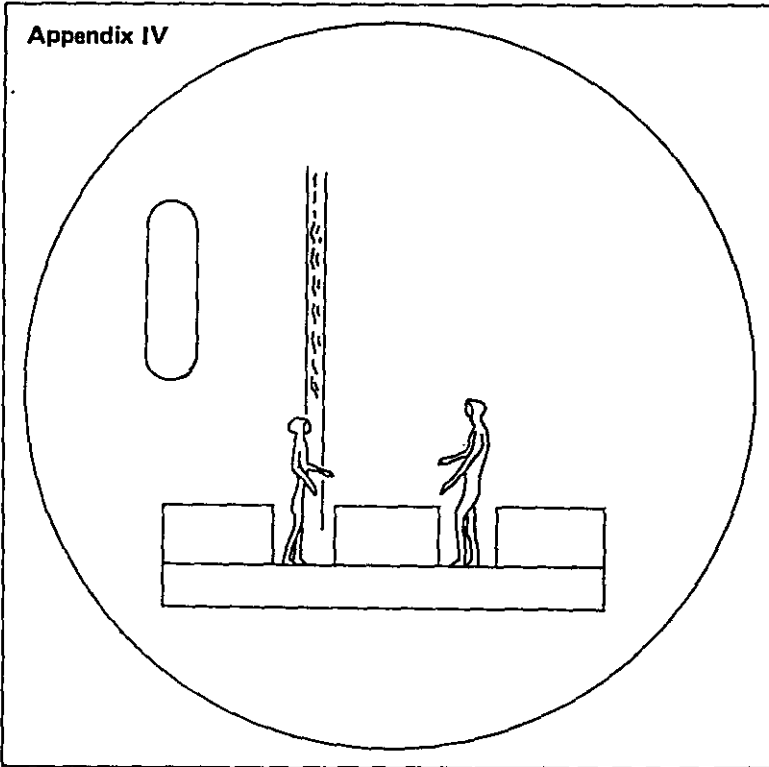
Right: The sighting from aboard the Spanish corvette *Atrevida*, at a point 3 sea-miles from the S.E. coast of Fuerteventura

Appendix II of the official document issued by the Ministry).

B: A very few minutes later, at about 21.30 hrs. - so the official report states - the foregoing testimony as



Appendix IV



Left:

The luminous sphere and the two beings in it, stated to have been seen in the northern part of Grand Canary Island, based upon the official sketches.

OUR COVER ILLUSTRATION is a reproduction of one of the 36 colour photographs taken by a private citizen near Maspalomas and Playa del Inglés in the southern part of Gran Canaria, and released by the Spanish Government. Our copy was kindly obtained by us by Sr.

given by the personnel of the corvette was corroborated by a total of eleven other witnesses, including the doctor at Guía, a place situated in the northern part of the neighbouring island of Grand Canary (Gran Canaria). The doctor's statement is included in the dossier on the case. This dossier was compiled by an officer of the rank of comandante juez-instructor who was specially appointed by the Air Ministry, and was forwarded by him directly to the top authority in the Ministry, in Madrid.

This doctor, named Don Francisco-Julio Padron León, is the physician for the town of Guía. Together with two other witnesses, he was astonished at the sight of a gigantic ball 'of an electric blue colour' hanging stationary about 50 metres from them, and at a height of little more than 2 metres off the ground. This was at a place called Las Rosas, between Gáldar and Agaete. The doctor was travelling by taxi at the time, going to visit a patient, and he had with him — in addition to the driver, Francisco Estévez, Santiago del Pino. The latter was the son of the sick woman, and he had come from his home at Guía to get the doctor. Both the taxi-driver and the young man Santiago del Pino were old acquaintances of [REDACTED].

Here is the gist of the statements which the doctor gave to the press. These statements agree with the versions given in the Ministry's official file:—

"We were chatting in normal fashion when, coming round a bend, we were utterly amazed to see, about 60 metres or so from us, a perfect sphere,

as perfect as though marked out with a compass, with a very beautiful grey or light-bluish periphery.

"We experienced a terrible feeling of cold. The chauffeur even started trembling. Especially when the taxi's radio, which had been turned on, suddenly cut out.

"The sphere was there, stationary and still, a few metres off the ground. I could not believe my eyes and said as much to my two companions. But it was a fact. That 'thing' was there all right, in the middle of the darkness of the night. And, inside it, were two strange and enormous beings. I can give you a description of them down to the last detail, for we had them under observation for almost twenty minutes, and at a very short range from us...

"The sphere was transparent: through its walls you could see, perfectly clearly, the stars in the sky behind it. It was just like a gigantic soap-bubble. What I mean to say is that it did not look metallic, but it looked like glass.

"Its diameter was about that of a two-storey house. Inside it, there was a sort of platform, silver-coloured, and, on the platform, some panels, and two huge figures... The panels or instruments had no corners or right angles. Everything about them was round...

"We were astonished at the great size of the beings: maybe 2 metres 80, or 3.00 metres. They were wearing black 'diver's helmets' and their clothing, which was very tight-fitting — was of a shade of red that I have never seen in my life... Their hands seemed to be enclosed in big 'cones,' also

blac
two
hanc
prof
dispi
"

wher

was
saw
gas
the
size,
The

while
terrif
some

The
just
with
the
"V

size,
stopp
high-
Island

shape
big vi

"W

all th

accou
ment.

lookin

compa

purpo
illusion

I was
felt I

The

who h

about

orated

which

the sha

bers in

herein.

A fi

on Thu

this sig

onions

diamete

the pla

having

the rest

This ab

conject

C: The

which

nearby

then an

shortly

the tow

of the

engers

black. I could see no sign of fingers anywhere. The two beings were facing each other, moving their hands about, and operating levers. They were in profile to us. What astounded me, personally, was the disproportional size of the back part of their heads.

"The chauffeur switched on the big spotlight, and when he did this the machine started to rise, till it was level with the top of a nearby house. Then we saw a transparent tube inside the sphere, and a bluish gas was coming out of this tube and moving round the sphere. And then the sphere started to grow in size, till it was as big as a twenty-storey building! The beings, and the platform, and the panels, meanwhile all remaining their original size. We were terrified, and we turned the car round and went to some nearby houses, and went inside one of them. The people there told us that their television had just blacked out. We remained there in the house, with the family, looking out through the window at the sphere.

"When the 'thing' had expanded to the enormous size, the gas or fluid that was moving round inside it stopped moving. Then, in a flash, after giving out a high-pitched whistle, the thing shot away towards the Island of Tenerife, and as it went it even changed shape and became spindle-shaped, surrounded by a big vivid white halo.

"When I talked later, when we were calmer, with all the other eyewitnesses who had seen it, our accounts of what we had seen were in perfect agreement. And I will tell you something else: when I was looking at the beings, I deliberately said to my companions that they were blue. I did this on purpose, trying to prove whether it was an optical illusion on my own part. And the others replied that I was wrong: that the clothing was red. So then I felt I had proved the reality of what I was seeing."

The statement given by this exceptional witness — who had been requested to say nothing to anyone about the case, is, as we have stated above, incorporated into the Report drawn up by the Air Ministry, which also contains a number of sketches showing the shape of the machine and of the two crew members inside it (See Appendix IV, which we reproduce herein.)

A further thing which must be mentioned is that on Thursday, June 24, that is to say, two days after this sighting, it was discovered that, in a field of onions at Gáldar, a circular area about 30 metres in diameter had been totally obliterated, the leaves of the plants all being burnt and showing signs of having been subjected to a high temperature, whereas the rest of the crop of onions was still quite normal. This affair of the onions led to much diversified conjecture in the district.

C: The same object described in the foregoing report, which had vanished from sight in the direction of the nearby island of Tenerife or, if not the same object, then another and identical one, was reportedly seen shortly afterwards by a vast multitude of people in the town of Puerto de la Cruz, on the western coast of the Island. It was also seen by the crew and passengers aboard the ferry plying to and from the

Island of La Palma. On this latter island of La Palma, and also on the Islands of Gomera and Hierro, the eyewitnesses — who were extremely numerous — called up the newspapers, the local radio stations, and the competent local authorities to report their sightings. We can cite, for example, among the many witnesses, the guards who were on duty at the transmitter of Televisión Española at Izaña (Tenerife).

2. Detection by Radar, and Photographs

The official report also describes how the passage of the object or objects was registered on the radar.

And, in addition to this, there were also photographs taken during that night. These were kept secret until the release of the Report by the Ministry.

These photographs were taken in the southern area of Gran Canaria Island — to be precise, near the residential areas of *Maspalomas* and *Playa del Inglés*.

One of the local residents of that area had no difficulty in taking the photographs, because the sphere remained stationary there for several minutes, very near to the shore and very low. Its features as shown in the photograph correspond with the accounts given above by the previous witnesses. The photographer also said that the object was very big.

The news that a private citizen — whose identity is being kept a strict secret — had photographed a UFO, at once came to the knowledge of the Guardia Civil authorities. On express orders from the Air Minister the Guardia Civil were at once mobilized and launched into the search for the photographer until he was located.

His evidence, amounting to a total of 36 colour photographs, was subjected to all necessary tests by the competent authorities, and their conclusion was that the possibility of faking was ruled out.

The photographs show a large luminous sphere at some height above the illuminated buildings of the residential zone near by. We attach herewith a copy of one of the 36 photographs. This has already been published in the newspaper *La Gaceta del Norte* — [see cover, and note on p.6].

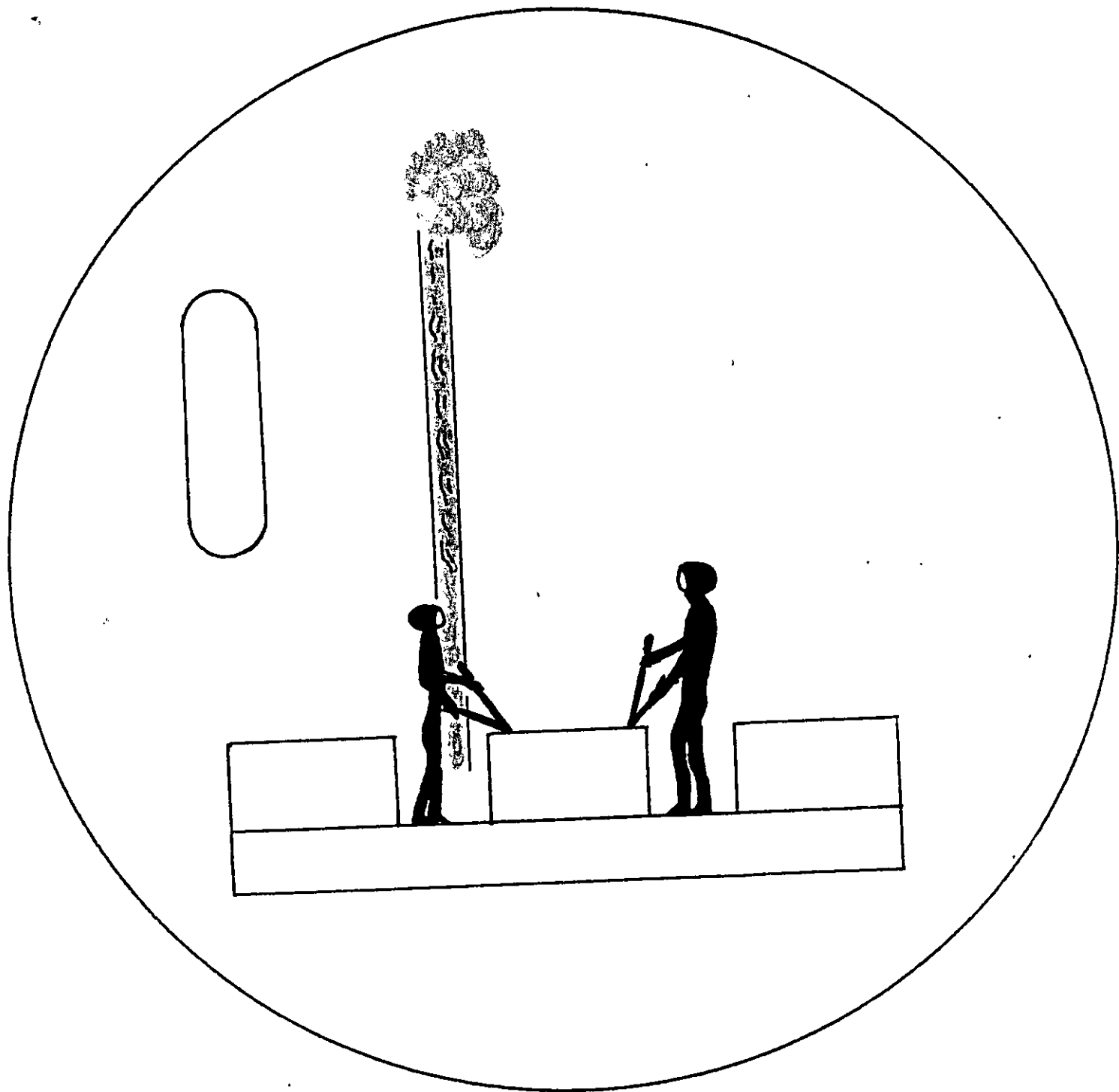
PERSONAL COLUMN

0.25 (\$0.65) per line or part, i.e. £1.00 (\$2.60) for 4 lines, and so on.

WANTED: 1955-1956 issues of FSR, paying up to £10.00 (PLEASE NOTE: British Pounds) (\$20.00 to \$25.00) per issue for mint condition. Also extremely interested in corresponding with seriously dedicated UFO researchers, publishers, writers from North America, South America, Europe, Asia, Australia, Africa etc. Bradford Johnson, P.O. Box 38, Allston, Mass 02134, U.S.A.

ADAMSKI Venusian Scout. UFO pictures in matt or gloss. SAE or international reply coupon for details to R. Lawrence, Hampstead HG Wells Society, 47 Belsize Sq. London NW3, England.

ITALIAN university student, interested in UFOs, seeks correspondents from all over the world. Write in English/French/Italian to: Massimo Cantoni, Via Kennedy 15, 21046, Malnate (Va.), Italy.



The "glass bubble" spacecraft of the Canary Islands, 1976.